

# NICHOLAS VEGA

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## About Me

Senior QA/Testing professional, 16 years in. Track record of taking ambiguous problems through design, delivery and the unglamorous operational work that follows. I mentor deliberately and write things down. Core stack: pytest, Postman, Docker.

## Selected Highlights

- Built a performance harness in CI/CD simulating 30k concurrent users.
- Mentored 4 manual testers into automation roles.
- Partnered with developers to shift testing left, embedding QA in refinement sessions.

## Professional Experience

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### Senior Quality Engineer

Spotify | November 2016 to June 2026 | South Michelle

- Wrote the team's testing strategy, separating unit, contract and end-to-end responsibilities.
- Introduced flaky-test quarantine, taking suite reliability from 4% to 85%.
- Owned release sign-off for 5 services, coordinating across product and support.
- Automated 2 regression suites with Java, cutting the manual test cycle by 60%.
- Reduced escaped defects by 18% through risk-based test prioritisation.

### QA Engineer

Datadog | August 2014 to October 2016 | Port Tarachester

- Cut end-to-end suite runtime from 6 hours to 5 minutes through parallelisation.
- Integrated automated checks into the Docker pipeline, blocking 40 faulty releases.
- Established test data management practices later adopted by 2 teams.
- Set up cross-browser and device coverage in CI/CD, catching defects staging had missed.

### Amazon — Junior SDET

January 2011 to June 2014 | Abigailtown

- Drove accessibility coverage from 40% to 90% of core journeys.
- Built the defect triage process and reporting the engineering leads still use.
- Interviewed and onboarded 50 new hires, shaping the hiring bar for the team.

### QA Analyst, IBM

September 2009 to October 2010 | Hardingberg (Remote)

- Took over an unowned service, documented it and brought it back under SLO.
- Presented the team's work at an internal engineering forum of 150+ colleagues.
- Reduced technical debt on a legacy component that had blocked 5 previous attempts.

## Academic Background

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### PhD, Information Systems

Halloway Institute of Technology | 2004 to 2009

Thesis: "Data governance in federated organisations"

### Bachelor, Electrical Engineering

Delft University of Technology | 2000 to 2003

## Technologies

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pytest • Postman • Docker • JavaScript • TypeScript • Python • Jira • Java • CI/CD • Git • BigQuery • MongoDB • SQL • Playwright • Vue.js

## Notable Projects

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### Home energy dashboard

Collects meter readings and renders them with JavaScript. Mostly an excuse to learn time-series storage properly.

### Commute optimiser

Pulls transit APIs and suggests departure times, built on CI/CD.

## Training & Certifications

Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900) — Microsoft, 2019

HashiCorp Certified: Terraform Associate — HashiCorp, 2016

Google Analytics Certification — Google, 2017

## Selected Publications

"Adoption barriers for self-service analytics" - technical report, 2010. Cited internally as the basis for the current design.

"Data governance in federated organisations" - technical report, 2009. Cited internally as the basis for the current design.